



Official Championship Curricula

# COMPUDON Junior Digital Citizenship Championship

— Think First —

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GRADES 3-5

AGES 8-11

# COMPUDON JUNIOR

*Before you react / trust / believe / share.*

## Official Championship Curricula

**Grades 3–5**

*Cyber Safety, Creativity & Critical Thinking,  
--Media Literacy, AI Literacy*

Inspired by the Microsoft Digital Literacy Standard, with extended modules on cyber safety, critical thinking, media literacy, and AI awareness, as covered by the COMPUDON Junior championship syllabus.

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## How to Use This Book

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This book prepares students in Grades 3–5 for the COMPUDON Junior championship and, more importantly, for safe and confident life in a digital world. Every module follows the same learning pathway, so students always know what to expect.

- Learning objectives tell you exactly what you will be able to do by the end of the module.
- Stories open every module. Read them first — they show real situations children face, and how thoughtful choices change outcomes.
- Concept sections explain each idea in simple words, with every new term defined the first time it appears.
- Memory rhymes help the brain hold on to the big idea. Read them aloud — twice!
- Key learnings summarise each section in three lines for quick revision.
- Think – Pair – Do activities turn knowledge into action — alone, with a partner, or with the class.
- Stretch sections, marked “Stretch — best for Grade 5 and curious explorers”, go deeper. Grade 3 and 4 students may read them with a teacher or parent.

### A promise to every reader

Nothing in this book is meant to frighten you. The internet is a wonderful place to learn, create and connect. This book simply gives you the same thing a seatbelt gives a traveller: freedom to enjoy the journey, safely.

### If you ever need help

Some chapters discuss difficult things such as online bullying. If anything in this book reminds you of something happening to you or a friend, the first and best step is always the same: tell a trusted adult — a parent, teacher or older family member. *If the first person you tell cannot help, tell someone else. Keep telling until someone listens and helps you. Speaking up is never wrong, and you deserve to feel safe.* In India, you and your family can also use these official channels:

- **Childline 1098** — a free, 24-hour helpline for any child who needs help or someone to talk to.
- **National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930** and the portal [www.cybercrime.gov.in](http://www.cybercrime.gov.in) — for reporting online fraud, harassment or misuse (an adult can help you file a report).
- **Emergency number 112** — for any urgent danger.

**Note for parents:** These helplines appear again inside the relevant modules. Please point them out to children before beginning Module 1.

## MODULE

# 1

## Digital Safety and Online Protection

**Pause and think** — “A small pause. A smarter choice.”

### BY THE END OF THIS MODULE, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- ✓ Recognise online harassment and explain why it is never the victim’s fault.
- ✓ Recognise and avoid unsafe online behaviour.
- ✓ Recognise pressure tactics and tricks used by strangers online.
- ✓ Describe why people sometimes behave unkindly online (anonymity, attention, the bystander effect).
- ✓ Apply the five-step safety plan: stay calm, don’t reply, save evidence, block and report, seek support.

### PROTECTING PERSONAL INFORMATION

- ✓ Understand what a digital footprint is and how online actions leave a lasting trail.
- ✓ Protect personal data — name, school, photos, and passwords — and use privacy settings wisely.
- ✓ Recognise why identity is the first line of defence and build strong, private login habits.

### FOLLOW THESE THREE STEPS



*Three steps that mean you never face it alone.*

**Remember:** the moment you share your challenge with a trusted adult, the problem stops being yours alone.

## 1.1 What Is Online Harassment?

**Real situations. Real choices. See what happens — and what you would do differently.**

### OPENING STORY

#### The Group Chat Explosion

*Arjun was excited when his class created a group chat for homework help. At first, everyone shared notes and funny memes. But one afternoon, a classmate posted a blurry photo of Arjun tripping in the corridor and added laughing emojis. More students piled on, sending jokes and nickname tags. Arjun read every message with a tight chest, hoping it would stop. It did not stop for five days. He started pretending to be sick so he would not have to face school.*

*His mother noticed he had stopped eating properly and sat beside him one evening. Arjun showed her the chat. Together, they took screenshots, reported the messages, and spoke with his teacher. The teacher addressed the class without naming Arjun. The jokes stopped. Slowly, Arjun returned to the group chat — this time knowing he had people on his side.*

**In the student's words:** *"The moment I showed someone, the problem stopped being mine alone."*

### MINI STORY

#### The Comment That Would Not Go Away

*Nisha loved writing short poems and posting them in her school's online reading club. One Tuesday, she posted a rhyme about the monsoon. Within an hour, one classmate wrote a mocking comment calling her poem "baby stuff". Two others liked the comment and added more teasing words. Nisha deleted her poem, but the comments stayed. She felt embarrassed and checked the page every ten minutes, hoping the words would disappear. They did not.*

*That night she told her older cousin, who immediately recognised it as online harassment because it was repeated, public, and meant to humiliate. Her cousin helped her take screenshots and report the comments to the club moderator. By morning, the comments were removed. Nisha's teacher spoke to the class about kindness in digital spaces without singling anyone out. Nisha posted her next poem the following Friday.*

**Online harassment** means repeated unkind behaviour towards a person using phones, computers or the internet. The key word is repeated — it is not one careless remark, but unkindness that keeps coming back, often in front of others.

### MEMORY RHYME

*Mean words that keep coming are never okay,  
Screenshot the proof, then block and report right away,  
Tell a trusted adult — what happened today,  
Speaking up is brave, help is on the way.*

## KEY LEARNINGS



- Online Harrassment means repeated unkind behavior using digital tools.
- Harassement is never the fault of the person being targeted.
- Saving proof and telling a trusted adult helps stop the problem.

## 1.2 Why Does Online Harassment Happen?

### MINI STORY

#### THE LAUGH THAT WENT TOO FAR

*During lunch break, someone in Riya's class started a poll in the group chat — "Who has the worst handwriting in Grade 4?" Three names appeared. Within minutes, students were voting and adding laughing emojis. Nobody had posted their real name on the poll. Riya saw it on her phone and felt uneasy, but she stayed silent, thinking someone else would say something. Nobody did.*

*That evening Riya mentioned it to her mother. Her mother asked one question: "If that poll had been on the classroom noticeboard with everyone's names on it, would anyone have put it up?" Riya shook her head immediately. "That," her mother said, "is exactly why people do things online they would never do in person."*

*The next morning Riya quietly told her teacher. The poll was removed. The teacher spoke to the class about how hiding behind a screen does not make unkindness invisible — it just makes it easier.*

**Knowing why people behave badly online makes you harder to fool — and harder to hurt.**

**Anonymity** means hiding one's real identity. When names and faces are hidden behind a screen, some people feel less responsible for their words. A child who would never tease someone face to face may write hurtful comments online, because distance changes how people feel about being responsible.

**Power and attention.** Some people feel strong or important when they control how someone else feels. Online, likes and laughing reactions can act like applause for unkindness. When a group laughs along, the sender feels supported — and empathy, which means understanding how others feel, gets switched off. People forget that a real person with real feelings sits behind the screen.

**The bystander effect** means people watch a wrong thing happen but do not help, each assuming someone else will act. Online, many students see mean comments and stay silent. To the harasser, silence can look like approval — even when it is not. This is why one kind, brave voice matters so much: it breaks the silence and changes the pattern for everyone.

**In the student's words:** *Anonymous doesn't mean harmless. Someone always gets hurt.*

## MEMORY RHYME

*A hidden name makes unkind words feel free,  
A crowd that laughs along is half the cruelty,  
And silence lets the meanness spread and grow,  
Till one brave, kinder voice, stops the show.*

## KEY LEARNINGS

- Anonymity makes some people feel less responsible for their words.
- Attention, power and low empathy can drive harmful online behaviour
- Speaking up kindly breaks the bystander effect and reduces online harm.

## 1.3 Smart Responses: The Five-Step Safety Plan

If harassment ever happens to you or a friend, you are not helpless. These five steps work in almost every situation.

**Step 1 — Stay calm.** Pause before reacting. Step away from the screen and take slow breaths. A calm mind makes better choices than an angry one.

**Step 2 — Do not engage.** Arguments feed harassment, because attention is exactly what many harassers want. You may reply once with a calm boundary, such as “Please stop” — and then stop responding completely.

**Step 3 — Save evidence.** Take screenshots of the messages before deleting or blocking anything. Note the dates and usernames. Saved proof helps adults, teachers and platforms understand exactly what happened.

**Step 4 — Block and report.** Blocking closes the door; reporting calls the helpers. Most apps have a report button under every comment and profile. In serious cases, an adult can also report through India's National Cyber Crime Portal ([cybercrime.gov.in](http://cybercrime.gov.in)) or call 1930.

**Step 5 — Seek support.** Talk to a trusted adult — a parent, teacher or older sibling. Talking shares the weight. If you ever feel you have no one to tell, Childline 1098 is a free helpline that listens to any child, any time. Afterwards, be kind to yourself: the unkind words are not true, and hobbies, sports and friends help confidence return.

### MEMORY RHYME

*Take a breath before you type — a cool head wins the day,  
Don't feed the fire, don't reply, just calmly walk away,  
Save the proof, then block, report — shut the door for good,  
Tell someone that you trust — they'll help you like they should.*

### KEY LEARNINGS

-  Staying calm and not engaging takes away the harasser's reward.
-  Saving evidence, blocking and reporting stop harmful behaviour.
-  Support from trusted adults and helplines rebuilds confidence and safety.

### THINK – PAIR – DO

1. **Think:** Write the five safety steps in your own words and put them in the correct order.
2. **Pair:** With a friend or sibling, act out helping someone who has received mean messages online. Practise saying:  
"This is not your fault. Let's tell a trusted adult together."
3. **Create:** Design a "Kindness Online" poster showing the five safety steps and the helpline numbers 1098 and 1930.



Check with your teacher about displaying your poster in your classroom or school notice board, or send it to the COMPUDON Junior team for possible publication on the website. Include your name and send it to [support@compudonjunior.com](mailto:support@compudonjunior.com).

## OPENING STORY 2

### The Password Mistake

*Priya shared her game account password with her best friend Meena so they could play together during the holidays. When school resumed, the two had a small argument over a project. The next day, Priya found that her game profile had been changed, her high scores were deleted, and strange messages had been sent to other players from her account. She felt confused and hurt.*

*That evening, Priya did not shout or post about it publicly. Instead, she changed her password immediately and spoke with her older brother. He explained that sharing passwords, even with trusted friends, creates risks. Priya later had a calm conversation with Meena, who admitted she had acted out of anger. They both learned that digital actions have real consequences, and that hurt feelings online can take longer to fix than the original argument.*

**In the student's words:** "A password is like a toothbrush — never share it, not even with a best friend."

## OPENING STORY 3

### The Fake Profile

*Kavya noticed a new profile following her class discussion board. The profile had no photo, a strange username, and kept posting rude comments under students' posts. Kavya felt uneasy but was unsure whether to say anything, worrying people might think she was overreacting. She mentioned it casually to her father while he helped with dinner.*

*He listened carefully and explained what anonymous accounts and fake profiles often do online. Together, they reported the profile to the platform, and her teacher was informed the next morning. The fake account was removed within a day. Kavya later shared what she had learned with her two friends who had also seen the account but stayed silent. She realised that noticing something wrong and telling a trusted adult is never overreacting. It is exactly the right response.*

**In the student's words:** "Speaking up early is not overreacting. It is exactly the right reaction."

## 1.4 Your Digital Footprint and Personal Information

### MINI STORY

#### The Trail Priya Did Not Know She Left

After the password incident, Priya's brother sat with her and opened her game profile. He showed her that her username contained her real name, her school's name appeared in her bio, and her profile photo was her school sports day picture. "Anyone who found this account could piece together who you are and where you go to school," he said quietly. Priya had never thought of it that way. She had only been thinking about the game.

Together they changed her username to something fun but anonymous, removed the school name, and replaced the photo with her favourite cartoon character. Her brother called what they removed her *digital footprint* — the trail of information people leave behind online without realising it.

**In the student's words:** *"I thought I was just playing a game. I didn't know I was also leaving a map to find me."*

A **digital footprint** is the trail of information you leave behind every time you use the internet — photos you post, names you write, schools you mention, and even the apps you log into. Once something is online, it is very difficult to remove completely. Even deleted posts can be saved and shared by others before they disappear.

**Personal information** is any detail that could help someone identify or locate you. This includes:

- Your full name
- Your school's name or location
- Your home address or neighbourhood
- Your photos — especially in school uniform
- Your phone numbers
- Your passwords

**A useful rule:** if you would not write it on a poster and stick it on your school gate, do not post it online.

**Privacy settings** are controls inside apps and websites that let you choose who can see your information. Always set profiles to *private* so only people you know can see your posts and details. Ask a trusted adult to help you check your settings on every app you use.

### MEMORY RHYME

*A name, a school, a photo shared —  
each one a clue for those who've dared,  
keep your details close and small,  
a private profile protects you all.*

## KEY LEARNINGS

A digital footprint is the trail of personal information you leave online — it is hard to erase completely.

- Personal information includes your name, school, address, photos, and passwords — protect all of them.
- Privacy settings control who sees your information — always set profiles to private with a trusted adult's help.

## 1.5 Passwords — Your First Line of Defence

### MINI STORY

#### The Toothbrush Rule

After Meena changed Priya's game account, their teacher asked the class a question: "How many of you have shared a password with someone?" Nearly every hand went up. The teacher smiled. "Let me ask you something else. How many of you have shared your toothbrush?" The class burst out laughing. Nobody had.

"A password is exactly like a toothbrush," the teacher said. "It is personal, it protects you, and sharing it — even with your best friend — creates a problem you did not expect." She wrote one sentence on the board and asked everyone to copy it into their notebooks.

*In the student's words: "A password is like a toothbrush — never share it, not even with a best friend."*

A **password** is the secret key that protects your accounts. A weak password is like a lock with no key — anyone can open it. A strong password makes it much harder for strangers to get in.

#### What makes a strong password:

- At least eight characters long
- A mix of letters, numbers, and symbols (example: *Sun\$et82!*)
- Nothing obvious — not your name, birthday, or pet's name
- Different for every account — never reuse the same password

#### Three password rules to remember always:

1. Never share your password with anyone — including friends — except a parent or trusted adult who needs to help you.
2. Never type your password when someone can see your screen.
3. If you think someone knows your password, change it immediately — just as Priya did.

A **strong login habit** also means logging out of accounts on shared devices — school computers, tablets, or a friend's phone — so your account does not stay open for others to use.

## MEMORY RHYME

*Long and mixed and hard to guess,  
a strong password causes less distress,  
never share it, log out well,  
your password is a secret — never tell.*

## KEY LEARNINGS

- A strong password is long, mixed, and unique — never your name or birthday.
- Never share your password with anyone except a trusted adult helping you.
- Log out of shared devices and change your password immediately if you think someone else knows it.

## THINK – PAIR – DO

1. **Think:** List three pieces of personal information you should never share online and explain why each one is risky.
2. **Pair:** With a partner, check an imaginary profile together — *Name: Rohan Sharma. School: India Charter School, Chennai. Student: Grade 5, loves cricket. Photo: school uniform.* How many things would you change? Why?
3. **Create:** Design a "Strong Password Recipe" card — like a recipe for your favourite dish, but the ingredients are the things that make a password strong. Share it with your family.



**Note for Parents:** Privacy settings change frequently. Visit [www.compudonjunior.com/safety](http://www.compudonjunior.com/safety) for up-to-date links to official privacy guides for Instagram, WhatsApp, YouTube and more. Links are checked and updated every six months.